



Super malaria

A newly-mutated strain of drug-resistant malaria has spread into Vietnam
<http://dgit.in/SupaMalaria>



Mexico damage map

NASA has released a damage map of the crazy Raboso earthquake that killed hundreds of people.
<http://dgit.in/MexicoDmg>

Sony Xperia XA1 Ultra

Bezel-less but needs work

Sony's Xperia XA branded smartphones have followed bezel-less form factors for a while, and this, the Xperia XA1 Ultra is the "biggest" of the lot. But then it also has some glaring flaws. Notice that there's no finger-print sensor on this ₹30,000 phone.

Also, the bezel-less design is somewhat wasted because of the two large glossy strips of plastic above and below the screen. Sony's display isn't the most colourful and it doesn't have AMOLED level contrast, but it brings a pleasant mix of everything.

From a performance point of view, the Xperia XA1 Ultra doesn't qualify as fluid or smooth. We've seen more fluid performance even on cheaper phones running the Snapdragon 625.

If we were to choose between the two cameras, Sony has done a better job with the front shooter here. It keeps photos natural, rather than excessive post-processing.

What we can't ignore though is the 2700 mAh battery on such a large form factor. The Xperia XA1 Ultra lasted just over 8 hours on the PC Mark Work 2.0 battery test.

The Xperia XA1 Ultra is a dependable smartphone, but at these price points it's difficult to justify that. The Xperia XA1 Ultra loses out to Samsung's phones in terms of display quality, performance and battery, while its camera prowess is decent at best. The Honor 8 Pro and slightly more expensive OnePlus 5 are far better smartphones (in all respects) than the Xperia XA1 Ultra.

—Prasid Banerjee



Price
₹31,990



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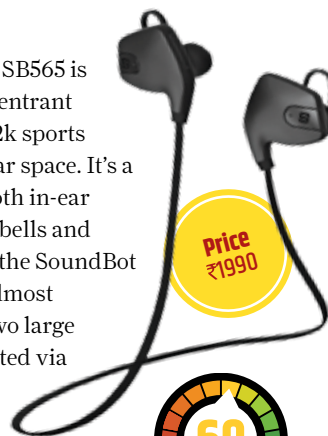
SoundBot SB565

Just your average bluetooth in-ears

The SoundBot SB565 is a brand new entrant into the sub-2k sports oriented bluetooth in-ear space. It's a pretty standard bluetooth in-ear without any noticeable bells and whistles. The design of the SoundBot SB565 is interesting – almost minimalist. You have two large driver housings connected via an appropriately long flat cable which is tangle free. One of the redeeming features of the SoundBot SB565 is the fact that despite the housings being bulky – and carrying the battery – they manage to remain light. For drawing performance comparisons and having a scale of reference we

kept two wireless in-ears handy – one was the SoundMagic E10BT while the other was the Degauss Labs Vice. The E10BT is in the vicinity of the SoundBot SB565, at least in terms of price. The Vice was used for the sake of having a much higher end reference since no direct comparisons can be made with it. The SoundBot SB565 is quite muted in its tonal representation. It does okay when dealing with EDM type tracks such as *Stereo Love*, but not much else. Metal tracks were subpar – there was discernable distortion in the bass notes and large sections of the spectrum were under-emphasised. Similarly, while playing *Ancestral - Steven Wilson*, details like high cymbals etc were lacking. If you have to purchase them at MRP (₹1990) you'd be much better off with something like a SoundMagic E10BT by upping your budget slightly. But if you get them for a discounted price, like the ₹1,569 price point they are currently selling for, you might just want to consider giving them a shot if you are feeling particularly generous.

—Siddharth Parwatay



Price
₹1990



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SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Mediatek MT6757 Helio P20 | GPU: Mali-T880MP2 | OS: Android 7.0 | CARD SLOT: microSD, up to 256 GB | DISPLAY TYPE: IPS Panel | SIZE: 6.0 inches | RESOLUTION: 1080 x 1920 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: 23 MP, f/2.0 PDAF | CAMERA SECONDARY: 16 MP, f/2.0, OIS.

CONTACT

SONY MOBILE INDIA | PHONE: 1800-103-7799 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: sonymobile.com/in/

SPECIFICATIONS

STANDBY TIME: Up to 6.6 days | RATED BATTERY LIFE: 6.5 Hrs call, 4.5 hrs music | SUPPORTS: HSP, HFP, A2DP, AVRCP | WIRELESS RANGE: 33 feet or 10 meter | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 4.0

CONTACT

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